

MScAC Initiative Budget Proposal

Event: MScAC Poker Social

Date: Friday, 27 Feb 2026, 3:00 PM to 9:00 PM

Venue: MScAC Room 9016

Estimated Attendance: 30 players + ~10 spectators

Purpose

To foster community engagement and strategic networking through a structured, high-energy social event. Following a busy academic period, this event provides a platform for students to connect outside of a technical environment. By leveraging the expertise of student organizers, we aim to provide a flexible tournament experience that builds camaraderie across the cohort, catering to both seasoned players and casual beginners.

Event Components

Poker Play & Optionality (3:00 PM – 6:00 PM):

- **Dual-Track Format:** To maximize inclusivity, the room will be split into two modes of play based on RSVP interest:
 - **Competitive Bracket:** A structured "Sit-and-Go" tournament for experienced players.
 - **Casual/Learning Tables:** A "cash-style" format (using play chips) allowing for flexible buy-ins/outs, ideal for those wanting to learn the game without the pressure of a tournament clock.
- **Table Logistics:** Utilization of 5 poker sets (all sourced from the office/students). 2–3 sets will be dedicated to each mode of play depending on final registration numbers.
- **Facilitation:** Kevin, Sander, and Tom will act as directors, managing blind structures for the tournament track and providing rule guidance for the casual track.

Dinner & Social (6:00 PM – 7:00 PM):

- **Catering:** Intermission dinner featuring a variety of options from local vendors (e.g., Pizza or Asian catering), served family-style.
- **Refreshments:** A selection of non-alcoholic beverages and light snacks available throughout the day.

Tournament Finals & Open Play (7:00 PM – 9:00 PM):

- **Main Event Final Table:** The top players from the competitive bracket move to a single "Final Table" with spectators invited to watch.
- **Consolation Tables:** Casual play continues on secondary tables for those eliminated from the main tournament.

Budget Breakdown

Item Description	Quantity	Estimated Cost
Catering: Main Dinner (Family-style trays)	For 40 people	\$700
Refreshments: Assorted sodas, water, and snacks	Bulk	\$100
Miscellaneous: Tablecloths, napkins, and disposable cutlery	1 Set	\$50

RSVP Plan

- **Initial Interest Polling:** Polling for the initially proposed date of Saturday February 27th showed at least 20 students were interested in participating. Given these students might bring a plus one and some didn't answer (e.g. Tom, Sander), 30 participants is a fair assessment of the final number of interested participants.
 - **Preference Tracking:** Final event RSVPs (sent out via Partiful) will include a "Play Style" question to determine the initial split between Competitive and Casual tables.
 - **Dietary Needs:** Standard collection of dietary restrictions via Partiful.
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Other Next Steps

- **Food provision:** Confirm dietary needs and delivery at 6 PM
- **Equipment Sourcing:** Sourcing of all poker sets from students
- **Rule Sheet:** Distribute a "Cheat Sheet" for hand rankings and house rules via Discord prior to the event.
- **Reporting:** Submit all itemized receipts, final attendee list, and invitation for reimbursement. (ESSENTIAL)

Total Budget Requested: \$850